

Word family: **fold / folds / folded / folding / foldable / folder**

Base word: fold

Past tense: folded

Past participle: folded

Related forms: folding, foldable

Useful family extension: folder

Useful expressions / extensions: fold paper, fold clothes, fold in half, fold your arms, fold up, fold away, fold into, fold in, business folds

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / related adjective and noun family (相關形容詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “He can spend hours playing with Lego, drawing imaginary cities, or **folding paper rockets** out of old notebooks.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **fold** means:

> **to bend paper over onto itself so that one part lies on or against another part**

Leo is using old notebook paper and bending it into shapes to make paper rockets.

繁體中文：把紙張彎折，使其中一部分疊到另一部分上；摺；摺疊

中文翻譯：

> “He can spend hours ... folding paper rockets out of old notebooks.”

「他可以花幾個小時.....用舊筆記本的紙**摺紙火箭**。」

Here:

fold paper = 把紙張按一定位置摺疊成形

1. **fold = bend paper/material over itself (摺) — 摺；摺疊**

This is the exact sense in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “He can spend hours ... **folding paper rockets** out of old notebooks.”

「他可以花幾個小時.....用舊筆記本的紙**摺紙火箭**。」

Practice 2

> “She **folded** the paper in half.”

「她把紙**對摺**。」

Practice 3

> “The child carefully **folded** the corner.”

「那個小朋友小心地把紙角**摺起來**。」

****fold = 把紙、布等柔軟物料彎折，使一部分疊到另一部分上****

2. ****fold in half (對摺) — 對摺；摺成兩半****

Practice 4

> “**Fold** the paper ****in half****.”

「把紙**對摺**。」

Practice 5

> “She **folded** the card ****in half****.”

「她把卡紙**摺成兩半**。」

****fold something in half = 把物件摺疊成兩個大致相等的部分****

3. ****fold clothes (摺衣服) — 摺好；疊好****

A very common everyday use.

Practice 6

> “She **folded** the clean clothes.”

「她把乾淨衣服**摺好**。」

Practice 7

> “Can you help me **fold** the towels?”

「你可以幫我**摺**毛巾嗎？」

fold clothes = 把衣物摺疊整齊，方便收納

4. **fold your arms** (雙臂交叉) — 抱臂；交叉雙臂

A common body-position use.

Practice 8

> “He **folded his arms** and waited.”

「他**交叉雙臂**等著。」

Practice 9

> “She stood there with her arms **folded**.”

「她站在那裡，**雙臂交叉**。」

fold your arms = 把雙臂彎曲並交叉放在胸前

5. **fold** = bend something flexible (摺彎) — 摺起；彎起

A broader physical sense.

Practice 10

> “The chair can be **folded** flat.”

「這張椅子可以**摺平**。」

Practice 11

> “He **folded** the map and put it away.”

「他把地圖**摺起來**收好。」

****fold = 把可彎曲物件摺起，使其體積變小或改變形狀****

6. ****fold up (摺起 / 摺合) — 摺起；收起****

A very common phrasal extension.

Practice 12

> “The table ****folds up**** easily.”

「這張桌子很容易****摺起來****。」

Practice 13

> “She ****folded up**** the blanket.”

「她把毛氈****摺起來****。」

****fold up = 把某物摺小、摺合或收起****

7. ****fold away (摺起收納) — 摺起收好****

Practice 14

> “The bed ****folds away**** into the wall.”

「這張床可以****摺起收進牆裡****。」

Practice 15

> “The chairs can be ****folded away**** when not in use.”

「椅子不用時可以****摺起收好****。」

****fold away = 把可摺疊物件收起，通常為節省空間****

8. ****foldable = able to be folded (可摺疊的) — 可摺的；摺疊式的****

Practice 16

> “They bought a **foldable** table.”

「他們買了一張**可摺疊桌子**。」

Practice 17

> “The phone has a **foldable** screen.”

「這部手機有**可摺疊螢幕**。」

foldable = 可以摺起或彎折，以改變大小 / 形狀的

9. **folding** + noun (摺疊式的) — 摺疊式；可摺合的

Practice 18

> “We brought **folding chairs**.”

「我們帶了**摺椅**。」

Practice 19

> “He uses a **folding bike**.”

「他使用一部**摺車 / 摺疊單車**。」

folding + noun = 可以摺起，通常方便收納或攜帶的

10. **fold** = crease / line made by folding (摺痕) — 摺痕；摺線

Now **fold** functions as a noun.

Practice 20

> “There is a **fold** in the paper.”

「紙上有一道**摺痕**。」

Practice 21

> “Make a sharp **fold** along the line.”

「沿著那條線摺出一道清晰的**摺痕**。」

****fold = 因摺疊而形成的彎位、摺線或摺痕****

11. ****fold = layer/overlapping section (褶皺) — 褶 ; 皺褶****

Especially with fabric, skin, or landscape.

Practice 22

> “The dress fell in soft ****folds****.”

「裙子垂下來形成柔和的****褶皺****。」

Practice 23

> “Water collected in the ****folds**** of the fabric.”

「水積在布料的****皺褶****中。」

****fold = 柔軟物料自然彎曲、重疊形成的褶皺部分****

12. ****fold = layer/curve in skin/body tissue (皮膚 / 組織褶皺) — 褶皺 ; 皺褶****

Practice 24

> “The cream should be applied between skin ****folds****.”

「乳霜應塗在皮膚****皺褶之間****。」

Practice 25

> “The doctor examined the tissue ****fold****.”

「醫生檢查了組織的****褶皺部分****。」

****fold = 皮膚或身體組織彎曲重疊形成的部分****

This is a common anatomical extension.

13. **fold = geological bend in rock layers (地質褶皺) — 褶皺**

A genuine technical sense.

Practice 26

> “The mountain contains several geological **folds**.”

「這座山有多個地質**褶皺**。」

Practice 27

> “Pressure caused the rock layers to **fold**.”

「壓力令岩層產生**褶皺**。」

fold = 岩層因壓力彎曲而形成的地質結構

14. **fold = group/community sharing beliefs (群體 / 陣營) — 團體；陣營**

A figurative noun sense.

Practice 28

> “He was welcomed back into the **fold**.”

「他重新被接納回這個**團體 / 圈子**。」

Practice 29

> “Several members returned to the political **fold**.”

「幾名成員重新回到原來的政治**陣營**。」

the fold = 一個有共同信念、身份或歸屬感的群體

This originally relates to a sheepfold, but in modern use it is often figurative.

15. **return to the fold (回歸群體) — 回歸；重新加入**

Practice 30

> “She eventually returned to the **fold**.”

「她最後重新**回到原本的圈子 / 團體**。」

Practice 31

> “The organization hopes to bring former members back into the **fold**.”

「該組織希望讓舊成員重新**回歸團體**。」

return/bring someone back into the fold = 重新加入原來所屬的群體、組織或信仰圈子

16. **fold** = sheep enclosure (羊圈) — 羊圈

A literal but lower-frequency noun sense.

Practice 32

> “The shepherd led the sheep into the **fold**.”

「牧羊人把羊帶進**羊圈**。」

Practice 33

> “The sheep stayed safely inside the **fold** overnight.”

「羊群晚上安全地留在**羊圈**裡。」

fold = 圍起來供羊群停留和受到保護的地方

This sense explains the figurative:

> “return to the fold”

but it is lower-priority everyday vocabulary.

17. **fold** = fail/close as a business (倒閉) — 倒閉；結業

A major figurative verb sense.

Practice 34

> “The company **folded** after losing too much money.”

「公司因虧損太多而**倒閉**。」

Practice 35

> “Several small shops **folded** during the downturn.”

「經濟低迷期間，有幾間小店**結業**。」

fold = 公司、企業或組織因財務 / 經營問題而停止運作

This is especially common in business/news contexts.

18. **fold** = give up / collapse under pressure (屈服 / 放棄) — 屈服；撐不住

A figurative extension.

Practice 36

> “He refused to **fold** under pressure.”

「他拒絕在壓力下**屈服**。」

Practice 37

> “The team did not **fold** when things became difficult.”

「情況變得困難時，團隊沒有**撐不住 / 放棄**。」

fold = 在壓力、困難或競爭下放棄、崩潰或停止抵抗

The metaphor is:

> something standing → folding/collapsing.

19. **fold** = withdraw from a card game (撲克牌棄牌) — 棄牌

A major gaming sense.

Practice 38

> “He **folded** after seeing the bet.”

「看到對方下注後，他選擇**棄牌**。」

Practice 39

> “You can call, raise, or **fold**.”

「你可以跟注、加注，或者**棄牌**。」

fold = 在撲克牌等牌局中放棄當前一局，不再繼續下注

This is a fully lexicalized modern sense.

20. **fold** = include / combine one thing into another (納入) — 納入；併入

A figurative extension.

Practice 40

> “The smaller team was **folded into** the larger department.”

「較小的團隊被**併入**較大的部門。」

Practice 41

> “The new service will be **folded into** the existing system.”

「新服務將會**納入**現有系統。」

fold something into something = 把某個部分納入、整合或併入更大的整體

21. **fold in** = gently combine ingredients (輕輕拌入) — 拌入

A major cooking sense.

Practice 42

> “**Fold in** the flour gently.”

「把麵粉輕輕**拌入**。」

Practice 43

> “She **folded the egg whites into** the mixture.”

「她把蛋白輕輕**拌入混合物**。」

fold in = 烹飪時用翻拌動作把材料輕柔混合，以免失去空氣或結構

This is not simply ordinary “mix.”

22. **fold = bend body forward/inward (蜷縮 / 彎下) — 彎下；蜷縮**

A physical extension.

Practice 44

> “He **folded** himself into the small chair.”

「他把身體**蜷縮進那張小椅子裡**。」

Practice 45

> “She **folded** forward with laughter.”

「她笑得整個人**彎下身來**。」

fold yourself/body = 令身體彎曲、縮合或收緊

23. **arms folded / legs folded (肢體交疊) — 手腳交叉 / 屈曲**

Practice 46

> “She sat with her legs **folded** beneath her.”

「她坐著，把雙腿**屈在身下**。」

Practice 47

> “He watched with his arms **folded**.”

「他**抱著雙臂**看著。」

****folded** = 身體部位彎曲並彼此交疊 / 收起******

24. ****fold** = multiplied by a number (.....倍) —倍******

Important: this is a suffix-like form, not the ordinary verb ****fold****, but it is worth recognizing.

Practice 48

> “Sales increased three****fold****.”

「銷售額增加到原來的****三倍****。」

Practice 49

> “There was a ten****fold**** increase.”

「增幅達到****十倍****。」

****fold** = 表示數量 / 程度是原來的若干倍******

Examples:

* twofold

* threefold

* tenfold

* manifold

This should be treated as a related form rather than another core meaning of the verb ****fold****.

25. ****twofold** = having two aspects / twice as much (兩方面 / 兩倍) — 雙重的 ; 兩倍的******

Practice 50

> “The purpose is ****twofold****.”

「目的有****兩方面****。」

Practice 51

> “Demand increased ****twofold****.”

「需求增加到原來的**兩倍**。」

****twofold = 有兩個方面；或數量達兩倍****

This is a lexicalized extension of ****fold****.

26. ****folder = container for papers (文件夾) — 文件夾****

A useful lexical-family extension.

Practice 52

> “Put the documents in the blue ****folder****.”

「把文件放進藍色****文件夾****。」

Practice 53

> “She organized the papers into separate ****folders****.”

「她把文件分別放入不同****文件夾****。」

****folder = 用來整理、保存文件的夾子 / 文件套****

27. ****folder = computer directory (電腦資料夾) — 資料夾****

A major computing sense.

Practice 54

> “Save the file in this ****folder****.”

「把檔案儲存在這個****資料夾****。」

Practice 55

> “Create a new ****folder**** for the photos.”

「建立一個新的****資料夾****來存放照片。」

****folder = 電腦 / 數碼系統中用來整理檔案和其他資料夾的虛擬容器****

Important distinction: **fold vs bend**

bend

is the broad word for changing something from straight to curved/angled.

fold

usually means:

> bend something so one part lies over/against another.

Compare:

> “Bend the wire.”

= 把鐵線彎曲。

> “Fold the paper.”

= 把紙摺起。

So **fold** usually involves overlapping sections.

Important distinction: **fold vs crease**

fold

= the action/result of bending material over itself.

crease

= the line/mark produced by folding, pressing, or wrinkling.

> “Fold the paper.”

= 摺紙。

> “There’s a crease in the paper.”

= 紙上有摺痕。

Important distinction: **fold vs roll**

fold

= bend over in sections.

roll

= turn something around itself into a curved/cylindrical shape.

> fold a towel

> roll a towel

Both are possible, but produce different shapes.

Important distinction: **fold vs crumple**

fold

= deliberate, controlled bending.

crumple

= crush into irregular wrinkles.

> carefully fold the paper

versus:

> crumple the paper into a ball.

Very different actions.

Important distinction: **fold clothes vs pack clothes**

fold clothes

= arrange clothes into neat flat sections.

pack clothes

= put clothes into a bag/suitcase/container.

You often fold clothes ****before**** packing them.

Important distinction: **fold your arms vs cross your arms******

These are almost equivalent.

**fold your arms******

and:

**cross your arms******

both mean:

> 抱臂 / 雙臂交叉

****Cross your arms**** is perhaps more transparent for learners; ****fold your arms**** is also very common.

Important distinction: **fold up vs fold away******

**fold up******

= collapse/fold into a smaller form.

**fold away******

= fold and store out of the way.

> “The chair folds up.”

= 椅子可摺起。

> “The chair folds away.”

= 椅子可摺起收好。

Important distinction: **fold in** — cooking vs mix

mix

= combine ingredients generally.

fold in

= combine gently using lifting/turning motions to preserve air/texture.

This distinction matters especially in baking.

Important distinction: **fold into** — combine vs physical fold

Physical:

> “Fold the paper into a triangle.”

= 把紙摺成三角形。

Figurative/institutional:

> “The unit was folded into another department.”

= 該單位被併入另一部門。

The second is metaphorical integration.

Important distinction: **fold** — business vs close

close

is neutral:

> stop operating.

fold

often suggests:

> business failure, especially financial inability to continue.

> “The shop closed.”

could be voluntary.

> “The shop folded.”

usually implies it failed.

Important distinction: **fold under pressure vs give up**

give up

= stop trying.

fold under pressure

= stop resisting specifically because pressure became too great.

The second has a stronger collapse metaphor.

Important distinction: **fold — poker vs quit**

fold

in poker is the technical action:

> withdraw from that hand.

quit

means:

> stop the game/activity entirely.

You can fold one hand and continue playing.

Important distinction: **fold — noun crease vs fold — group**

Physical:

> “a fold in the fabric”

= 布料的褶皺。

Figurative group:

> “return to the fold”

= 回到原本群體。

These are genuinely different learner-relevant senses.

Important distinction: **fold** vs **-fold**

This needs careful labeling.

fold

verb/noun:

> 摺 / 褶 / 倒閉 / 棄牌 etc.

-fold

suffix-like form:

> twofold / tenfold

= 兩倍 / 十倍，或雙重 / 十重

They are historically related but should **not** be taught as though “threefold” were just an ordinary meaning of the verb **fold**.

Important distinction: **folder** vs **fold**

fold

= verb/noun relating to bending/creases.

folder

= a container for organizing papers or digital files.

For learner-facing curation, **folder** is worth including as a lexical family extension, but it is **not** another meaning of bare fold.

Family-extension note

Fold is a strong moderate polysemy word.

Its major semantic centres are:

- * **bend material over itself** → fold paper/clothes
- * **crease/overlapping layer** → a fold in fabric
- * **body parts crossed/bent**
- * **collapse/fail** → a business folds
- * **give way under pressure**
- * **poker: withdraw from a hand**
- * **group/community** → return to the fold
- * **cooking: fold in**
- * **integration** → fold into a larger system
- * **geological/anatomical fold**

The family sweep then adds:

- * **folding**
- * **foldable**
- * **folder**
- * **-fold / twofold / tenfold**

These should be labelled accurately as lexical extensions rather than forced into the bare verb's meaning count. That matches the manual's word-family sweep and conservative splitting principles.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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fold — paper/material	把紙、布等柔軟物料彎折，使一部分疊到另一部分上
fold in half	把物件摺成兩個大致相等的部分
fold clothes	把衣物摺疊整齊，方便收納
fold your arms	把雙臂彎曲並交叉放在胸前
fold — flexible object	把可彎物件摺起，使其縮小或改變形狀
fold up	把某物摺起 / 摺合成較小形態

fold away	把物件摺起並收好	
foldable	可以摺起或彎折的	
folding + noun	可以摺合、方便收納 / 攜帶的	
fold — crease	因摺疊而形成的摺痕 / 摺線	
fold — fabric layer	布料等自然彎曲形成的褶皺部分	
fold — anatomical	皮膚 / 組織彎曲重疊形成的褶皺	
fold — geology	岩層受壓彎曲形成的地質褶皺	
the fold — group	有共同信念、身份或歸屬感的群體 / 圈子	
return to the fold	重新回到原來所屬的團體 / 圈子	
fold — sheep enclosure	圍起來供羊群停留和受保護的羊圈	
fold — business	因財務 / 經營問題停止運作；倒閉	
fold — under pressure	因壓力太大而屈服、崩潰或停止抵抗	
fold — poker	在牌局中放棄當前一手牌，不再繼續下注	
fold into	把某部分納入、整合或併入較大的整體	
fold in — cooking	用輕柔翻拌動作把材料混合，以保持空氣 / 結構	
fold body/self	令身體彎曲、蜷縮或收合	
-fold	表示數量 / 程度是原來的若干倍	
twofold	有兩個方面；或達兩倍	
folder — paper	用來整理和保存文件的文件夾	
folder — computing	電腦中用來整理檔案的虛擬資料夾	

For your original sentence

> “He can spend hours playing with Lego, drawing imaginary cities, or **fold**ing paper rockets out of old notebooks.”

The exact meaning is:

fold = 把紙張彎折並疊合，使它逐步形成某種形狀

Therefore:

> **fold**ing paper rockets

= “「摺紙火箭」”

This is the straightforward **paper-folding / shape-forming sense**.

It is not:

* **a business folded** = 公司倒閉

* **fold in the flour** = 輕輕拌入麵粉

* **fold in poker** = 棄牌

* **return to the fold** = 回歸原本群體

* **tenfold** = 十倍

In the passage, the word reinforces Leo's **hands-on creativity**: he is not merely drawing imaginary objects—he is physically turning flat paper into three-dimensional creations.